

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Threat Hunting, SIEM/Splunk, Escalation Lead, Threat Intelligence
United Kingdom (Hybrid/London) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience in senior cyber security analyst roles, specialising in security operations, threat hunting, threat intelligence, and incident escalation. I am highly experienced acting as a senior escalation point for complex cyber incidents and working as part of global security teams, bridging operational detection with strategic threat intelligence and business risk. I have broad experience across the full cyber security landscape — from SIEM management and EDR/XDR operations to insider risk, breach attack simulation, network security, and adversary tradecraft. I am proficient in SIEM platforms including Splunk (SPL), Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, and I have deep, hands-on expertise in Endpoint Detection and Response using CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE). I am experienced in conducting packet, file, and log analysis; building and tuning detection rules; coordinating breach attack simulation exercises; and procuring and applying threat intelligence to drive proactive threat hunting. I am comfortable acting as a mentor and knowledge-sharer within security teams and am passionate about continuous improvement, staying ahead of the threat landscape, and contributing to a culture of security excellence.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Splunk (SPL, dashboards, alerts, correlation rules); Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, workbooks, SOAR playbooks); CrowdStrike NG-SIEM
- **EDR/XDR Solutions:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) — expert level; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR)
- **Threat Hunting and Intelligence:** SIEM-driven and hypothesis-led threat hunts; adversary tradecraft analysis (MITRE ATT&CK); threat intelligence procurement and application; log, file, and packet analysis
- **Breach Attack Simulation and Insider Risk:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); insider risk programme management; DLP monitoring; behavioural analytics
- **Security Operations and Incident Response:** Senior escalation lead for complex cyber incidents; NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle; playbook authoring; escalation and mentorship within global teams
- **Network and Endpoint Security:** Firewalls (Check Point Harmony); IDS/IPS management and tuning; proxy servers; email security gateways (Mimecast); data loss prevention (DLP)
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory); Conditional Access; MFA/SSO; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM); Group Policy
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; AppCheck; Nessus; Pentera BAS; coordinated remediation and MTTR tracking
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; SOAR playbook development; Microsoft Sentinel automated response playbooks
- **Security Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK; NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF); CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Serve as the senior escalation point for complex cyber security incidents across an 8,000-user institution, managing end-to-end incident response in accordance with the NIST 800-61 lifecycle and leading cross-functional coordination with technology and business teams
- Conduct regular hypothesis-led and SIEM-driven threat hunting exercises across Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM (SPL), incorporating procured threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK adversary tradecraft to identify malicious activity before impact

- Operate and tune CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR), writing and maintaining detection analytics rules across endpoint, identity, email, and network layers
- Manage Splunk and Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environments, including data connector health, analytics rule tuning, log source ingestion quality, and dashboard and workbook maintenance
- Lead log and event data analysis across SIEM and EDR platforms, performing packet and file analysis to qualify threats and reduce false positive volumes
- Manage insider risk monitoring programme, coordinating DLP alerts and behavioural signals with HR and Legal stakeholders in line with policy frameworks
- Administer breach attack simulation exercises using Pentera BAS, validating detection and prevention control effectiveness against real-world adversary techniques
- Manage firewalls (Check Point Harmony), IDS/IPS, proxy controls, and email security gateways (Mimecast), investigating anomalies and tuning policies to reduce exposure
- Oversee vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS; coordinate remediation with technical teams and report MTTR metrics to senior leadership
- Act as a mentor and knowledge-sharer within the security team; champion process improvement and continuous development of team capability

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed and managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform, building hybrid SOC capability covering endpoint detection, alert triage, and threat investigation; acted as primary CrowdStrike subject matter expert within the team
- Performed proactive day-to-day SIEM operations including alert triage in Splunk and Microsoft Sentinel, EDR event analysis, IDS/IPS monitoring, and threat hunting activities
- Contributed to log and file analysis, correlating events across SIEM, EDR, firewall, and email gateway sources to qualify threats and support escalated incident investigations
- Supported 8,000-user Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment, including policy configuration, onboarding, and sustained alert management
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO; maintained BeyondTrust PAM and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus; reported findings and coordinated remediation with technical and application owners
- Participated in ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, and JISC cyber security compliance activities; contributed to audit and risk assessment processes

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed day-to-day security operations in a SaaS/FinTech environment, including SIEM monitoring, alert triage, and incident escalation to senior analysts
- Administered endpoint security tooling, Check Point Harmony firewall, and network security controls; monitored IDS/IPS and proxy alerts and investigated anomalies
- Managed Microsoft Azure cloud security services including identity and access management, MFA/SSO, and Group Policy for a distributed workforce
- Conducted vulnerability scanning, patch management, and remediation tracking; supported penetration test finding resolution
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities and provided security requirements for change initiatives at the design stage

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Established and led end-to-end threat hunting capability at UAL, combining SIEM (Splunk and Sentinel), threat intelligence, and MITRE ATT&CK adversary tradecraft to proactively identify and neutralise threats before business impact

- Served as senior escalation lead and incident commander for complex cyber security incidents, consistently minimising dwell time and business impact in line with NIST 800-61
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR from the ground up, building a hybrid SOC environment with full endpoint visibility and mature detection engineering across a large, distributed institution
- Administered Pentera BAS programme to continuously validate control effectiveness against real-world adversary techniques, directly improving detection coverage and reducing mean time to respond (MTTR)
- Built and maintained Microsoft Sentinel workspace, data connectors, analytics rules, and SOAR playbooks, enabling automated detection and response across the security estate
- Mentored junior analysts and championed continuous improvement, contributing to uplift of team capability and knowledge sharing across security operations functions

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)